

Your Neighbours Are Putting on a Race — And It's Going to Be a Party

If you've spent any time near Bronte Harbour Park on a weekend morning, you know the red shirts.

They gather at the gazebo — coffee from Peach, a bit of stretching, a lot of laughing — and then head out along the waterfront. Sometimes a small group, sometimes thirty people. Wednesday evenings too. Those are the Bronte Runners, and they've been doing this for years.

Greg Kowalczyk and Charles Sathmary have been leading the group for most of that time. Different paces, different distances, but the same loop past the water every time. Eventually, the question became obvious.

"We'd finish our runs and just sit there by the harbour," Greg says. "Looking out at the water, watching families walk by, thinking — why isn't there a race here? Why aren't we celebrating this place?"

So they're doing it. On **Father's Day, June 21, 2026**, the Bronte Harbour Classic 5K comes to Bronte Harbour Park.

It's a Race. It's Also a Festival.

The 5K starts at 8:00 AM along the waterfront — chip-timed, flat, stroller-friendly, with views that most race courses can only dream about. There's also a Kids 1K Fun Run for ages 2–12, with medals for every finisher.

But the event runs all day, until 3:00 PM, and you don't need to be a runner to show up. The plan is live music, a kids' activity area (jumping castles, face painting), a vendor expo featuring local Bronte businesses, and an awards ceremony in the afternoon. Free to attend for anyone who wants to come and enjoy the waterfront.

The Bronte Runners group isn't new to pulling things together for the community — last year they were Oakville's largest fundraising team for the Terry Fox Run, raising \$27,000. For this event, they've brought in Greg Pace, who's been directing the Moon in June race in Burlington for 35 years, to help with race operations. CIBC is the founding sponsor. On Running is on board for prizes. The Town of Oakville has given its support.

Father's Day and Oakville Dads

There's a reason the event landed on Father's Day specifically. The Bronte Harbour Classic has partnered with **Oakville Dads** — a local organization that supports fathers and families in our community — as its charity of choice. Donations will be collected at the event, and every dollar stays local. It felt like the right fit for a morning when families are already together and looking for something to do.

Run the race, or just come for the morning. Either way, you're supporting something that gives back to Oakville families.

For Bronte Businesses

The Bronte BIA is a community partner for this event, and Kylie Wilson has been connecting local businesses with the opportunity to participate. There are a few ways to get involved:

Vendor Expo Booths — \$250

A 10x10 booth for the day, right in the middle of a festival with 800+ registered participants plus spectators and families. Vendors can also include materials in participant swag bags at no extra charge.

Swag Bag Sponsorship — \$250

If a full day at a booth isn't possible, businesses can put a card, coupon, or sample directly into every participant bag. Eight hundred people, one drop-off.

Sponsorship

Levels run from \$850 up to \$8,000 for title sponsorship. Since this is Year 1, the rates are what they are — they'll go up for future events.

For more information, contact Greg at greg@tapegeeks.com or 905-334-9282.

Save the Date

Sunday, June 21, 2026

Bronte Harbour Park, Oakville
8:00 AM – 3:00 PM

Register to run: bronteharbourclassic.com

Vendor/sponsorship inquiries: greg@tapegeeks.com

*Organized by Bronte Runners. Supporting Oakville Dads Charity. Community partner: Bronte BIA.
Founding sponsor: CIBC.*